

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Central maritime question and its root dependence

CENTRAL QUESTION -> how does India secure a maritime space it does not control?

ROOT CONDITION -> more than half of India's trade traverses the Strait of Malacca

|
v formative shock: 26/11 terrorists hijacked an Indian fishing vessel

AXIS 1 -> RULES: UNCLOS ratified 29 June 1995; BBNJ signed 25 September 2024

AXIS 2 -> AWARENESS: IFC-IOR 2018, Gurugram; IORA; IONS 2008

AXIS 3 -> PARTNERS: island-state vision documents; non-treaty minilaterals

RULE -> dependence is the premise; every later instrument answers it

MUST REMEMBER: The Indo-Pacific and Indian Ocean framework links sea-lane security,...

MUST REMEMBER: The Indo-Pacific and Indian Ocean framework links sea-lane security,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Doctrine ladder: SAGAR to MAHASAGAR

12 MARCH 2015, MAURITIUS -> SAGAR: Security and Growth for All in the Region

|-- security cooperation + economic and developmental partnership

v

12 MARCH 2025, PORT LOUIS -> MAHASAGAR: Mutual and Holistic Advancement for
Security and Growth Across Regions; trade for development; capacity building;
mutual security; technology sharing, concessional loan and grants

SAME SPEECH -> India is moving ahead with the SAGAR Vision

LIMIT -> extension of scope to the Global South; declared vision, not a treaty

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Legal-status ladder in the maritime order

10 DECEMBER 1982 -> India signs the Convention on the Law of the Sea
-> 29 JUNE 1995: India ratifies; domestic zones under the 1976 Maritime Zones Act
-> 19 JUNE 2023: BBNJ adopted -> 20 SEPTEMBER 2023: opened for signature
-> 25 SEPTEMBER 2024: India signs -> 19 SEPTEMBER 2025: 60th ratification lodged
-> 17 JANUARY 2026: BBNJ enters into force
STATUS -> India is a signatory and not a party as of 3 August 2026
COST -> a non-party cannot vote at the Conference of the Parties

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Three distinct mechanisms, three distinct functions

IORA -> regional intergovernmental organisation; 23 members; 12 dialogue partners

Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025-27 from November 2025

IONS -> voluntary naval-cooperation symposium, established 2008;

India assumed the chair on 20 February 2026

IFC-IOR -> Indian Navy information-fusion centre, 2018, Gurugram; November 2025:

25 partner countries and International Liaison Officers from 15 countries

TRAP -> three separate bodies, never interchangeable names for one mechanism

LIMIT -> a chairship is agenda-setting and convening power, not control

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: India's own capability instruments

FAR EASTERN NAVAL COMMAND -> Port Blair, cited as a regional engagement instrument

MILAN -> biennial naval-fleet gathering running since 1995

ReCAAP -> multilateral anti-piracy cooperation India actively participates in

SAGAR PRAHARI BAL -> Indian Navy force raised in 2009 for base and
vulnerable-point protection

BOUNDARY -> operations route to the Internal Security maritime and coastal owner

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Maldives instrument priced component by component

7 OCTOBER 2024 -> India-Maldives Joint Vision for Comprehensive Economic and Maritime Security Partnership

USD 400 MILLION + INR 30 BILLION -> currency-swap arrangement

LEVEL: arranged facility, not evidence of drawdown

25 JULY 2025 -> FTA Terms of Reference signed and negotiations launched;

INR 4,850 crore Line of Credit

LEVEL -> Terms of Reference launch talks; they do not conclude an agreement

READING -> India answered political distance with more instruments, not fewer

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Colombo Security Conclave category matrix

STATUS ON 20 NOVEMBER 2025, NEW DELHI, NSA-LEVEL MEETING

MEMBER	Bangladesh India Maldives Mauritius Sri Lanka
OBSERVER	Seychelles
GUEST	Malaysia

9 FEBRUARY 2026 -> India welcomed Seychelles' decision to become a full member

MISSING -> no officially recorded effective accession date

TRAP -> member, observer, guest and decided to join are four separate claims

ASCTI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Indo-Pacific architecture and its seven pillars

4 NOVEMBER 2019, BANGKOK, 14th EAST ASIA SUMMIT -> Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative

PILLARS -> maritime security | maritime ecology | maritime resources |

capacity building and resource sharing | disaster-risk reduction and management |

science, technology and academic cooperation | trade, connectivity, maritime transport

ASEAN CENTRALITY -> the Initiative and the ASEAN Outlook are complementary

FORUMS -> East Asia Summit is leaders-led; ASEAN Regional Forum builds confidence

LIMIT -> not a treaty, alliance or centralised funding body; weak enforcement

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Minilateral capability against structural asymmetry

MALABAR -> India-US exercise; Japan added; regular Australian participation from 2020

PROVES: interoperability among all four Quadrilateral states

DOES NOT PROVE: any collective-defence obligation

THAROOR'S ASYMMETRY -> Washington holds long-established treaty relationships that other members, India included, do not share among themselves

CONSEQUENCE -> the grouping supplements Indian capacity; it never substitutes for it

OWNERSHIP -> the grouping's institutional profile belongs to topic 10

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: AUKUS pathway and its open questions

15 SEPTEMBER 2021 -> AUKUS announced by Australia, the UK and the United States

TRACK 1 -> conventionally armed, nuclear-powered submarines for Australia

TRACK 2 -> cyber, artificial intelligence, quantum, further undersea capabilities

MARCH 2023 PATHWAY -> rotational UK-US presence from as early as 2027;

Virginia-class sale from the early 2030s subject to US approval; later SSN-AUKUS

JUNE 2022 -> EUR 555 million settlement over the cancelled French programme

NOVEMBER 2025 -> IAEA Article 14 safeguards arrangement still under negotiation

INDIA -> not an AUKUS member; its Quadrilateral route is parallel and non-treaty

CLOSE DISTINCTION: UNCLOS membership is not acceptance of every maritime claim, freedom...

CLOSE DISTINCTION: UNCLOS membership is not acceptance of every maritime claim, freedom...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Sectoral rule-making at the International Maritime Organization

1948 CONVENTION ADOPTED -> 1958 ENTRY INTO FORCE -> UN specialised agency
ORGANS -> Assembly (all members) | Council (executive) | MSC, MEPC, Legal, TC, FAL
INSTRUMENTS -> SOLAS | MARPOL | Ballast Water Management, in force 2017 |
 Hong Kong ship recycling, in force 26 June 2025
1 JANUARY 2020 -> global sulphur limit cut from 3.50% to 0.50% m/m
2023 GHG STRATEGY -> net zero by or around 2050, with 2030 and 2040 checkpoints
OCTOBER 2025 -> Net-Zero Framework approved at committee level, NOT adopted; adjourned
INDIA -> elected to Council Category (b) for 2026-27; access, not guaranteed outcomes
EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Verify grouping membership, exercise...
EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Verify grouping membership, exercise...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a maritime demand

OPEN -> name the sea-lane dependence and the exact interest it creates

BUILD -> rules, awareness and partners, each with one dated instrument at its level

TEST -> price external-power basing, island-state agency and minilateral asymmetry

CLOSE -> qualify the net security provider label and give a graded contested-order verdict